

# SPROUT STORY

## MARKETING STRATEGY & GROWTH FOUNDATION

From a compelling concept to a repeatable growth system.

### THE CORE IDEA

**Turn reading practice into a story a child feels was made just for them.**

#### **Personalized • Playful • Educational**

This strategy keeps the original deck's visual and emotional language, then matures the thinking into a practical foundation for building, launching, learning and scaling Sprout Story in the U.S. market.



A clean operating document for the team: strategy → execution → measurement → learning → scale.

# 01 • STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

The job is not to market an education app. It is to create a product experience parents can understand, children want to repeat, and families want to share.

| NORTH STAR                                                                                        | POSITIONING                                                                                                                                 | MARKETING JOB                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Make reading practice feel personally meaningful — then prove that the fun is producing learning. | Learning That Doesn't Feel Like Work.<br>Personalized reading as an active alternative to passive screen time and dry drill-style practice. | Move a parent from “ <b>this is cute</b> ” to “ <b>this is for my child</b> ” to “ <b>this works</b> ” — with the product doing the proving. |

## THE STRATEGIC CHAIN

| 1. RECOGNITION     | 2. MAGIC           | 3. PROOF                 | 4. PRIDE               | 5. HABIT                 |
|--------------------|--------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|--------------------------|
| “That’s my child.” | “That’s my story.” | “They actually read it.” | “Look what they made.” | “Let’s do the next one.” |

### FOUNDATION PRINCIPLE

Do not scale acquisition before the activation moment is consistently strong. The no-signup experience is the bridge between the promise in the ad and the value of the product.

# 02 • AUDIENCE & MESSAGE ARCHITECTURE

Build around the parent’s job-to-be-done, while designing every touchpoint so the child becomes the emotional proof.

| PRIMARY BUYER                                                                                                                       | CHILD EXPERIENCE                                                                                                                                  | TRUST LAYER                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Parent / caregiver</b><br>Wants reading progress without another battle, while feeling confident the product is useful and safe. | <b>Hero, not student</b><br>The child chooses a world/adventure, sees their name, reads/listens, answers a short quiz and earns visible progress. | <b>Safety + transparency</b><br>Privacy and safety messaging should be prominent. The source deck explicitly calls for “COPPA-Compliant & AI-Guarded” trust language. |

## MESSAGE LADDER

| EMOTIONAL               | FUNCTIONAL                                     | PROOF                                           | ACTION                     |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Your child is the hero. | Personalized stories matched to reading goals. | Story + comprehension quiz + progress feedback. | Create your child's story. |

## CREATIVE RULE

Lead with the child’s identity and emotional reaction. Follow with educational proof. Avoid feature dumps.

# 03 • THE GROWTH FUNNEL

One system, four jobs. Each stage has a different promise and a different success signal.

| 01 • AWARENESS                                                                                                                                                        | 02 • ACTIVATION                                                                                                                                                                | 03 • VIRALITY                                                                                                                                                             | 04 • RETENTION                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Job:</b> earn attention<br><b>Promise:</b> “Your child can be the hero.”<br><b>Assets:</b> Meta/TikTok creative, seasonal hooks, diagnostic, teacher starter kits. | <b>Job:</b> deliver the magic before friction<br><b>Promise:</b> “See it for yourself.”<br><b>Assets:</b> no-signup sandbox, first story, AI narration, quiz, progress report. | <b>Job:</b> turn pride into distribution<br><b>Promise:</b> “Share what they made.”<br><b>Assets:</b> achievement links, Story Gift, milestone covers, co-hero referrals. | <b>Job:</b> create a reason to return<br><b>Promise:</b> “There is another story waiting.”<br><b>Assets:</b> weekly episodes, progress snapshots, birthday adventures. |

## PRODUCT LOOP

| ADULT SETS        | CHILD CHOOSES     | READ & LISTEN      | COMPREHENSION    |
|-------------------|-------------------|--------------------|------------------|
| Goal + vocabulary | World + adventure | Level-matched text | 3 quiz questions |

### OPERATING RULE

Every campaign should be mapped to one funnel job. If an asset tries to do awareness, conversion, retention and education all at once, simplify it.

# 04 • CHANNEL & CREATIVE SYSTEM

Keep one brand idea, but adapt the execution to the behavior of each platform.

| CHANNEL              | ROLE                                                  | CREATIVE BEHAVIOR                                                                                                              | PRIMARY KPI                        |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Facebook / Instagram | High-intent acquisition + parent/community conversion | Polished transformation: bedtime battle → co-created story → quiz proof. One hero image, one child name, one promise, one CTA. | Activated users / CAC              |
| TikTok               | Attention + reaction-led discovery                    | Over-the-shoulder reaction when the narrator says the child's name, pet or hobby. Fast, authentic, micro-viral.                | Qualified clicks / activation rate |
| Parent communities   | Trust + organic discovery                             | Useful resources, parent stories, milestone moments and shareable achievements — not hard-sell feature posts.                  | Engaged referrals                  |
| Teachers             | Credibility + parent bridge                           | Free printable "5-Minute Custom Reading Warm-Ups" and teacher-to-parent homework bridge.                                       | Resource → parent conversion       |

## THE 3-PART META SEQUENCE

| 01 • STOP                                                 | 02 • BELIEVE                                                    | 03 • ACT                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "Wait... that's my name!"<br>Show the personalized cover. | "And it actually helps them read."<br>Show story + quiz result. | "Create your child's story."<br>Send directly into the no-signup experience. |

# 05 • CONVERSION & ACTIVATION

The strongest acquisition system is one where the ad promise and first product experience are almost identical.

| AD                | LAND              | MAGIC         | PROOF           | NEXT                |
|-------------------|-------------------|---------------|-----------------|---------------------|
| Personalized hero | No-signup sandbox | Build a story | Quiz + progress | Sign up / subscribe |

## FRICTION TO REMOVE

| FRICTION                      | DESIGN RESPONSE                                                                             |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Account wall before value     | Let adults and children build the story, complete the quiz and see progress before sign-up. |
| Unclear educational value     | Make comprehension feedback visible and understandable immediately.                         |
| Generic creative              | Personalize the visual hook: child name, companion, world or interest.                      |
| Weak reason to return         | Weekly episodes, progress snapshots and birthday adventures.                                |
| Referral feels like marketing | Make sharing a child achievement or “Story Gift,” not a generic referral request.           |

### COMMERCIAL PRINCIPLE

Treat the free starter as a proof mechanism, not just a pricing tier. The source deck's ladder is 1 story/week with basic text + quiz score, then paid at \$7.99/month for unlimited stories, multi-chapter series, full AI narration and richer parent reporting.

# 06 • RETENTION & ORGANIC GROWTH

A child’s finished story should create the next acquisition event and the next reason to return.

| MOMENT               | EXPERIENCE                                           | GROWTH EFFECT                  |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Story finished       | Celebration + comprehension result + milestone cover | Child pride; parent sees proof |
| Parent sees progress | Simple progress snapshot / weekly report             | Trust + subscription value     |
| Family receives it   | Shareable achievement / animated Story Gift          | New household discovery        |
| New child joins      | Sibling/friend co-hero mode                          | Low-friction referral loop     |
| Next week            | New episode / new adventure                          | Habit + reactivation           |

## RETENTION PROGRAM

| WEEKLY                                 | MONTHLY                       | MILESTONE                           |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| New episode + parent progress snapshot | New world / theme / challenge | Printable cover + achievement share |

### LOOP TO REPEAT

Child finishes story + quiz → parent sees achievement → family/friend receives shareable link → new parent enters → new child creates a story.

# 07 • MEASUREMENT & EXPERIMENTATION

Measure the system in the same order the customer experiences it. Do not let cheap clicks hide weak activation.

| STAGE          | CORE METRIC                          | WHAT IT TELLS US                                 |
|----------------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Awareness      | Qualified CTR / engaged view rate    | Does the creative make the right parent curious? |
| Activation     | Story-start → story-complete rate    | Does the product deliver the promised magic?     |
| Learning proof | Quiz completion + progress-view rate | Does fun connect to visible learning value?      |
| Conversion     | Starter → paid conversion            | Does demonstrated value justify payment?         |
| Retention      | Week 1 / Week 4 return rate          | Is there a durable habit?                        |
| Virality       | Share rate + referred activation     | Does pride create organic growth?                |
| Economics      | CAC, payback, LTV trend              | Can the acquisition engine scale responsibly?    |

## EXPERIMENTATION SYSTEM

| TEST ONE VARIABLE                                                                       | KEEP A WEEKLY LEARNING LOG                                                | SCALE ONLY WHAT SURVIVES                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hook, visual, CTA, audience, landing experience or offer<br>— not five changes at once. | Record hypothesis → test → result → decision. Build institutional memory. | Winning ads become templates; winning product moments become product loops. |

# 08 • HOW WE WORK

The strategy becomes a foundation only when it turns into a repeatable operating rhythm.

| WORKSTREAM       | OWNER MINDSET                                 | OUTPUT                                            | CADENCE       |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Customer insight | Stay close to parent + child behavior         | Insight bank, objections, reactions, testimonials | Weekly        |
| Creative         | Make the product understandable in one glance | Hooks, scripts, variants, winning templates       | Weekly        |
| Product growth   | Remove friction before adding complexity      | Activation improvements, onboarding tests         | Biweekly      |
| Lifecycle        | Give families a reason to return              | Episodes, progress moments, reactivation          | Weekly        |
| Analytics        | Turn activity into decisions                  | Funnel dashboard + experiment readouts            | Weekly        |
| Trust            | Make safety visible, not buried               | Privacy/safety language, approvals, guardrails    | Every release |

## WEEKLY GROWTH MEETING

| 01            | 02                 | 03                      | 04                       |
|---------------|--------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| What changed? | What did we learn? | What will we test next? | What do we stop / scale? |

### DECISION RULE

The team should leave each week with fewer assumptions, a clearer funnel, and a small number of high-quality experiments — not a larger list of tasks.

## 09 • 90-DAY BUILD ROADMAP

Build the foundation in sequence: prove the message, prove activation, then scale the loops.

| PHASE 1 • FOUNDATION                                                                                                                                                                                    | PHASE 2 • PROOF                                                                                                                                                                                  | PHASE 3 • SCALE                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Weeks 1–4</b><br>Lock positioning and message hierarchy.<br>Define core audience hypotheses.<br>Instrument funnel events.<br>Build no-signup activation path.<br>Create Meta/TikTok creative system. | <b>Weeks 5–8</b><br>Run structured creative tests.<br>Measure activation and story completion.<br>Test free starter → paid path.<br>Launch achievement sharing.<br>Start weekly learning rhythm. | <b>Weeks 9–12</b><br>Scale winning creative patterns.<br>Expand seasonal/community programs.<br>Improve retention loops.<br>Formalize referral mechanics.<br>Set CAC/payback guardrails. |

### NON-NEGOTIABLES

|   |                                                           |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Sell the moment of recognition before the feature list.   |
| 2 | Keep the first experience low-friction and tangible.      |
| 3 | Show learning proof through story + quiz + progress.      |
| 4 | Turn finished stories into shareable pride.               |
| 5 | Protect trust with visible privacy and safety messaging.  |
| 6 | Scale only after activation and retention are understood. |

# SPROUT STORY

THE FOUNDATION IN ONE PAGE

Make the child feel seen. Let the parent see proof. Make the next story inevitable.

| BRAND                                                            | PRODUCT                                                                 | GROWTH                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Your child is the hero.<br>Learning that doesn't feel like work. | Personalized story → reading/listening → quiz → progress → achievement. | Recognize → activate → prove → share → return. |

This document matures the supplied Sprout Story concept deck into an operating strategy while preserving its core positioning, funnel, creative system, activation loop, retention ideas and commercial framing.

Source basis: Sprout Story — Marketing Concept Deck (7 pages).